

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Eleven

Coloniality

*The residue of concluded invasions:
five independent Nigerian sub-systems*

Coloniality is the system that forms when Invasion or Settler Colonialism has reached ascension but ended and wasn't properly dismantled. Structural residues and ascension ritual mechanisms were leftover and went on to form their own independent systems. In Nigeria, five: Epistemic Oppression, Linguicism (English), Colorism, Texturism, and Colonial Christianity. This is the framework's most directly Nigerian chapter.

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CHAPTER 11 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Coloniality

This is the framework's most directly Nigerian chapter. Coloniality is the system that forms when Invasion (Chapter 9) or Settler Colonialism (Chapter 10) has reached ascension but ended and wasn't properly dismantled. Structural residues AND ascension ritual mechanisms were leftover and formed their own independent systems. In Nigeria, Coloniality is the residue of the concluded British colonial invasion.

Every Nigerian alive today lives inside Coloniality. The outline names five sub-systems: **Epistemic Oppression**, **Linguicism (English)**, **Colorism**, **Texturism**, and **Colonial Christianity**. Each is an independent system that arose from the British colonial invasion but now operates on its own, no longer requiring the British to enforce it.

A note on method. The framework's outline explicitly **waives** the naive approach for Coloniality specifically. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections may reference pre-existing structural residues and ascension ritual mechanisms, because Coloniality's triads, networks, and residues exist within and because of those prior mechanisms, not independently of them. The Hegemonic Domain section ties this together.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 10. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. This chapter's blanks are especially personal: every Nigerian reader will find themselves in at least three of the five sub-systems, because Coloniality is the air we breathe.

Contents

Coloniality	1
Contents	1
1. Definition: What Coloniality Extracts, Enforces, and Removes	3
1.1 The Five Sub-Systems	3
1.2 What Coloniality Extracts	4
1.3 What Coloniality Enforces	4
1.4 What Options Coloniality Removes	4
2. The Interpersonal Domain	6

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Western Epistemic Standard	6
3.2 Enforcement Triad: English Language Standard	6
3.3 Enforcement Triad: Light Skin Standard	7
3.4 Enforcement Triad: Loose/Relaxed Hair Standard	7
3.5 Enforcement Triad: Colonial Christian Standard	8
3.6 Extraction Triad: Cognitive Labour to Western Frame	8
3.7 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Language Suppression	9
3.8 Extraction Triad: Beauty Performance Labour for Whiteness	9
3.9 Extraction Triad: Body Modification for Whiteness	10
3.10 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Religion Suppression	10
3. The Disciplinary Domain	12
4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars	12
4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network	13
4. The Structural Domain	15
5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures	15
5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings	15
5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions	16
5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual	17
6.1 Canon — Rewriting History	17
6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality	18
6. When Did Coloniality Rewrite History?	21
7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination	22
Question 1: When did Coloniality rewrite your reality?	22
Question 2: How is Coloniality causing your Death?	22
8. Endnotes & References	24
Coming Next	26

SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Coloniality Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Coloniality is the system that forms when Invasion or Settler Colonialism has reached ascension but ended and wasn't properly dismantled. Structural residues AND ascension ritual mechanisms were leftover and went on to form their own independent systems. The foundational theoretical text is Anibal Quijano's 'Coloniality of Power' (2000), which argued that colonial relations of power persisted after formal decolonisation.

Walter Mignolo's *The Idea of Latin America* (2005) and *The Darker Side of Western Modernity* (2011) extended the analysis to show that coloniality is the dark side of modernity itself — the two are inseparable. Sylvia Wynter's 'Unsettling the Coloniality of Being' (2003) showed how coloniality goes to the level of being itself, the category of the human. Sabelo Ndlovu-Gatsheni's *Coloniality of Power in Postcolonial Africa* (2013) and *Epistemic Freedom in Decoloniality* (2021) applied the analysis to the African context.

For Nigeria specifically, Mahmood Mamdani's *Citizen and Subject* (1996) showed how the colonial state's bifurcation of the population into citizen and subject persisted after independence. Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o's *Decolonising the Mind* (1986) supplied the analysis of coloniality as linguistic. Chinua Achebe's *Things Fall Apart* (1958) and *The Education of a British-Protected Child* (2009) documented the encounter as literary anthropology.

1.1 The Five Sub-Systems

Epistemic Oppression is the system that ranks Western knowledge above all other knowledge. The Western peer-reviewed journal, the Western university, the Western theoretical canon, the Western citation practice — each is treated as the source of real knowledge. African knowledge systems — the Ifa corpus, the Igbo oracle systems, the Hausa Islamic scholarship, the Tiv Akombo — are treated as 'anecdotal' or 'traditional' rather than knowledge.

Linguicism (English) is the system that ranks English above all other languages. English is the language of education, government, commerce, and professional life. The indigenous languages — Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, and hundreds of others — are 'vernacular.' The English accent is professional; the Nigerian accent is 'broken.' Pidgin is informal. The English-medium school is superior to the indigenous-medium school.

Colorism is the system that ranks light skin above dark skin. The Yoruba standard of beauty historically celebrated dark skin; the colonial encounter imposed the Western standard that valorises light skin. The bleaching cream industry is the most visible expression. The preference for light-skinned spouses, news anchors, actors, and politicians is the structural expression.

Texturism is the system that ranks loose or relaxed hair above natural African hair. The Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa standards historically celebrated indigenous hair textures; the colonial encounter imposed the Western standard that valorises loose texture. The wig, weave, and perm industries are the visible expression. The professional requirement of relaxed hair is the structural expression.

Colonial Christianity is the system that ranks the colonial-imported version of Christianity above indigenous religions and above the indigenous versions of Christianity. Christianity arrived with the colonial missions in the 1840s and was imposed through the school system. The colonial Christian Canon presents African religion as pagan or demonic. The Nigerian who adopts a Christian name in place of an indigenous name is performing the assimilation.

1.2 What Coloniality Extracts

Coloniality extracts five things, one per sub-system. **From Epistemic Oppression:** the cognitive labour the Nigerian academic performs to frame Nigerian problems in Western terms, the citation labour the Nigerian researcher performs to cite Western sources, the translation labour the Nigerian student performs to render Nigerian thought in English.

From Linguicism: the suppression of indigenous languages, the labour of learning English to a professional standard, the labour of suppressing the indigenous language in formal settings. **From Colorism:** the beauty performance labour of applying bleaching cream, the medical cost of skin damage, the psychological cost of internalised inferiority.

From Texturism: the beauty performance labour of relaxing hair, the cost of wigs and weaves, the medical cost of scalp damage from chemical relaxers, the psychological cost of internalised inferiority. **From Colonial Christianity:** the suppression of indigenous religion, the labour of performing the colonial Christian identity, the financial cost of tithes to the colonial church.

1.3 What Coloniality Enforces

Coloniality enforces five standards, one per sub-system. **From Epistemic Oppression:** the Western epistemic standard that requires Nigerian knowledge to be framed in Western terms, validated by Western institutions, and cited in Western journals. **From Linguicism:** the English language standard that requires Nigerian formal life to be conducted in English.

From Colorism: the light skin standard that valorises light skin in media, politics, and corporate life. **From Texturism:** the loose/relaxed hair standard that requires Nigerian professional women to wear relaxed hair, wigs, or weaves. **From Colonial Christianity:** the colonial Christian standard that treats the colonial Christian frame as the default religion of public life.

1.4 What Options Coloniality Removes

Concretely, Coloniality removes the option to cite African sources without Western validation. The Nigerian academic who would rather cite the Ifa corpus as a primary source is told it is not

‘peer-reviewed.’ The Nigerian researcher who would rather publish in an African journal is told it does not count for promotion.

It removes the option to conduct formal life in an indigenous language. The Nigerian lawyer who would rather address the court in Yoruba is told it is not permitted. The Nigerian legislator who would rather debate in Hausa is told it is not done. The Nigerian doctor who would rather explain the diagnosis in Igbo is told it is not professional.

It removes the option to be dark-skinned without social cost. The Nigerian actress who would rather not bleach is told she is too dark for the role. The Nigerian news anchor who would rather not bleach is told she does not have the ‘look.’ The Nigerian politician’s wife who would rather not bleach is told she is not ‘presentable.’

It removes the option to wear natural hair in professional settings. The Nigerian banker who would rather wear her natural hair is told it is not ‘neat.’ The Nigerian lawyer who would rather wear locs is told it is not ‘professional.’ The Nigerian student who would rather wear her natural hair is told it violates the dress code. It removes the option to practice indigenous religion without social cost. The Nigerian who would rather consult the Ifa priest is told they are ‘backwards.’ The Nigerian who would rather perform the ancestral ritual is told they are ‘demonic.’ Each removal is enforced by institutions, by the market, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH WAIVED

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The framework's outline waives the naive approach for Coloniality. The five enforcement triads and five extraction triads below are described with reference to the pre-existing structural residues (English-only official documents, English-only court proceedings, the Western-accredited universities, the bleaching cream regulatory failure, the cosmetic industry regulation, the colonial-era statutes) and ascension ritual mechanisms (the Canon that the West is the source of knowledge, the Practice of daily English use) because Coloniality's triads exist within and because of those prior mechanisms.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Western Epistemic Standard

The enforcer is the academic institution or professional body that demands Nigerian knowledge conform to the Western epistemic standard. The university that requires publication in Western journals for promotion. The professional body (NMC, COREN, ICAN) that requires Western accreditation. The conference that requires Western framing. The supervisor who demands the Western theoretical canon.

The enforcement is performed by the promotion criteria, by the accreditation requirement, by the conference selection process, by the supervisor's demand, or by the citation practice. The subject conforms by framing Nigerian knowledge in Western terms, by citing Western sources, by seeking Western publication, by adopting the Western theoretical canon.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian academic who would rather cite the Ifa corpus as a primary source loses the option to promotion, because the Ifa corpus is not 'peer-reviewed.' The Nigerian researcher who would rather publish in an African journal loses the option to reputation, because the African journal does not have an 'impact factor.' The Nigerian student who would rather theorise from Nigerian experience loses the option to a good grade, because the experience is 'anecdotal.'

The witness is the Nigerian academic or professional who watches the Western epistemic enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves cite only Western sources and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Western academic who benefits from the citation of Western sources without personally commanding the citation hierarchy.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: English Language Standard

The enforcer is the institution that demands English be used. The school that requires English at all times. The court that conducts proceedings in English. The legislature that debates in English. The office that requires English in meetings. The hospital that requires English in consultations. The enforcement is performed by the school policy, by the court procedure, by the legislative rule, by the

office culture, or by the hospital protocol.

The subject conforms by using English — the Nigerian child speaks English at school, the Nigerian litigant addresses the court in English, the Nigerian legislator debates in English, the Nigerian worker presents in English, the Nigerian patient explains in English. The conforming act is the English itself.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian child who would rather learn in their mother tongue loses the option to cognitive development in the language UNESCO has shown is superior for early education. The Nigerian litigant who would rather address the court in Yoruba loses the option to legal voice. The Nigerian patient who would rather explain their symptoms in Igbo loses the option to medical understanding.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the English enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves use English and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the English-speaking professional who benefits from the English standard without personally commanding it.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Light Skin Standard

The enforcer is the institution or individual that demands the subject conform to the light skin standard. The media house that hires light-skinned news anchors. The Nollywood casting director who casts light-skinned actors in leading roles. The political party that fields light-skinned candidates in visible positions. The corporate employer that promotes light-skinned staff to front-office roles. The family that prefers light-skinned spouses for its children.

The enforcement is performed by the hiring decision, by the casting decision, by the candidate selection, by the promotion decision, by the marriage approval, or by the social commentary. The subject conforms by applying bleaching cream, by avoiding the sun, by performing the light skin standard through chemical and behavioural means.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The dark-skinned Nigerian actress loses the option to leading roles, which is to say, loses the option to a career. The dark-skinned Nigerian news anchor loses the option to the primetime slot. The dark-skinned Nigerian corporate employee loses the option to front-office positions. The dark-skinned Nigerian woman loses the option to marriage preference.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the light skin enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves apply bleaching cream and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the bleaching cream manufacturer who profits from the standard without personally commanding it.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Loose/Relaxed Hair Standard

The enforcer is the institution that demands the subject conform to the loose or relaxed hair standard. The bank that requires female staff to wear relaxed hair or wigs. The school that requires female students to wear relaxed hair or specific styles. The office that requires female staff to wear 'neat' hair, which means relaxed. The media house that requires female presenters to wear weaves.

The enforcement is performed by the dress code, by the grooming policy, by the casting decision, by the promotion decision, or by the social commentary. The subject conforms by relaxing their hair, by wearing a wig, by wearing a weave, or by otherwise performing the loose/relaxed hair standard.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian banker who would rather wear her natural hair loses the option to the job, because the dress code forbids it. The Nigerian lawyer who would rather wear locs loses the option to the court, because the grooming policy forbids it. The Nigerian student who would rather wear her natural hair loses the option to school, because the dress code forbids it. The loss is financial, professional, and educational.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the hair enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves wear relaxed hair and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the wig, weave, and perm industry that profits from the standard without personally commanding it.

3.5 Enforcement Triad: Colonial Christian Standard

The enforcer is the religious institution or social structure that demands the subject conform to the colonial Christian standard. The church that demands the congregant reject African religion. The family that demands the child take a Christian name. The school that demands the student learn the colonial Christian curriculum. The social structure that treats Christianity as the default religion of public life.

The enforcement is performed by the church's teaching, by the family's naming decision, by the school's curriculum, by the social pressure, or by the explicit condemnation of indigenous religion. The subject conforms by adopting the Christian name, by rejecting the indigenous religion, by performing the colonial Christian identity.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian who would rather practice their indigenous religion loses the option to social standing, because the religion is treated as pagan or demonic. The Nigerian who would rather give their child an indigenous name loses the option to social acceptance, because the name is treated as unchristian. The Nigerian who would rather perform the ancestral ritual loses the option to community, because the ritual is treated as demonic.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the colonial Christian enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves practice colonial Christianity and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the colonial church that receives the converted Nigerian as a member, with the tithe that comes with membership.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Cognitive Labour to Western Frame

The extractor is the academic system that requires the Nigerian to perform cognitive labour in the Western frame. The Western journal that requires the Nigerian researcher to frame their work in Western terms. The Western conference that requires the Nigerian presenter to use Western theory. The Western university that requires the Nigerian student to cite Western sources. The extraction is performed by the publication requirement, by the conference selection, by the citation practice.

The subject conforms by performing the cognitive labour. What is extracted is the cognitive labour itself — the work of framing Nigerian problems in Western terms, the work of citing Western sources, the work of translating Nigerian thought into English. The labour is invisible because it is performed as ‘academic work.’

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian researcher loses the option to develop African theory, because the time is spent translating into Western terms. The Nigerian student loses the option to think in their own language, because the thinking must be in English. The Nigerian academic loses the option to build on African sources, because the sources do not count.

The witness is the Nigerian academic who watches the cognitive labour extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves perform the same labour. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Western academic establishment that benefits from the Nigerian’s cognitive labour without personally commanding it.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Language Suppression

The extractor is the linguistic system that requires the suppression of indigenous languages. The English-medium school that punishes the child for speaking their language. The English-only court that requires the litigant to use English. The English-only office that requires the worker to use English. The English-only hospital that requires the patient to use English. The extraction is performed by the school policy, by the court procedure, by the office culture, by the hospital protocol.

The subject conforms by suppressing their indigenous language. What is extracted is the language itself — the cognitive, cultural, and emotional resource that the indigenous language provides. The extraction is performed through the body of the speaker, who learns to suppress the indigenous language and to perform English instead.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian child loses the option to cognitive development in their mother tongue. The Nigerian litigant loses the option to legal voice. The Nigerian patient loses the option to medical understanding. The Nigerian nation loses the option to the languages that have carried its thought for millennia — the United Nations estimates that many Nigerian languages will be extinct by the end of the century.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the language suppression and does not intervene, or who themselves suppress their own language. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the English-speaking Nigerian who benefits from the English standard without personally commanding the suppression.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Beauty Performance Labour for Whiteness

The extractor is the beauty industry that requires the Nigerian to perform beauty labour for whiteness. The bleaching cream manufacturer that requires the Nigerian woman to apply the cream daily. The cosmetic company that requires the Nigerian woman to buy the foundation in the light shade. The fashion industry that requires the Nigerian model to be light-skinned. The extraction is performed by the marketing, by the product design, by the modelling requirement, by the social pressure.

The subject conforms by performing the beauty labour. What is extracted is the labour and cost of beauty — the time spent applying bleaching cream, the money spent on the cream, the medical cost of skin damage, the psychological cost of internalised inferiority. The labour is performed as ‘self-care.’

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian woman who applies bleaching cream loses the option to bodily health, because the cream damages the skin. The Nigerian woman who would rather not bleach loses the option to social standing. The Nigerian woman who internalises the light skin standard loses the option to self-acceptance.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the beauty labour extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves perform the same labour. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the bleaching cream manufacturer who profits from the standard without personally commanding the labour.

3.9 Extraction Triad: Body Modification for Whiteness

The extractor is the hair industry that requires the Nigerian to modify their body for whiteness. The chemical relaxer manufacturer that requires the Nigerian woman to apply the relaxer. The wig manufacturer that requires the Nigerian woman to wear the wig. The weave supplier that requires the Nigerian woman to sew in the weave. The extraction is performed by the marketing, by the product design, by the grooming policy, by the social pressure.

The subject conforms by modifying their body. What is extracted is the body modification itself — the chemical relaxing of the hair, the sewing of the weave, the wearing of the wig. The extraction is performed through the body of the subject, who learns to modify the body to fit the Western texture standard.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian woman who applies chemical relaxer loses the option to scalp health, because the relaxer damages the scalp. The Nigerian woman who wears the wig loses the option to bodily comfort. The Nigerian woman who would rather wear her natural hair loses the option to professional acceptance. The Nigerian woman who internalises the Western texture standard loses the option to self-acceptance.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the body modification extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves perform the same modification. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the wig, weave, and perm industry that profits from the standard without personally commanding the modification.

3.10 Extraction Triad: Indigenous Religion Suppression

The extractor is the religious system that requires the suppression of indigenous religion. The colonial church that requires the Nigerian to reject their indigenous religion. The missionary school that requires the Nigerian child to learn the colonial Christian curriculum. The colonial Christian family that requires the child to take a Christian name. The extraction is performed by the church teaching, by the school curriculum, by the family naming decision, by the social pressure.

The subject conforms by suppressing their indigenous religion. What is extracted is the religion itself — the ceremony, the ritual, the knowledge, the practice that has carried the community for millennia. The extraction is performed through the body of the subject, who learns to suppress the indigenous religion and to perform the colonial Christian identity instead.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian who would rather practice their indigenous religion loses the option to social standing. The Nigerian who would rather give their child an indigenous name loses the option to social acceptance. The Nigerian who would rather perform the ancestral ritual loses the option to community. The Nigerian nation loses the option to the religions that have carried its thought for millennia.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the religious suppression and does not intervene, or who themselves suppress their own religion. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the colonial church that receives the converted Nigerian as a member, with the tithe that comes with membership.

Nascent forms of this system include: ‘The West is the source of knowledge’, ‘African knowledge is not real knowledge’, ‘Peer-reviewed’ as Western gatekeeping, ‘Theory’ as Western canon, Citing only Western sources, Dismissing African sources as ‘anecdotal’, ‘Speak English’, ‘Speak proper English’, ‘Your English is good’, Judging accents, The RP accent as professional, Pidgin as inferior, Indigenous languages as ‘vernacular’, English as the language of sophistication, English as the language of education, English as the language of government, The English-medium school as superior, ‘Light-skinned’, ‘Dark-skinned’ as insult, The bleaching cream industry, The preference for light-skinned spouses, The preference for light-skinned news anchors, The preference for light-skinned actors, The preference for light-skinned politicians, ‘Good hair’, ‘Soft hair’, ‘Relaxed hair’ as professional, Natural hair as unprofessional, The wig industry, The weave industry, The perm industry, The Brazilian hair import, Judging natural hair, Judging locs, Judging short hair on women, ‘The Bible says’, ‘African religion is pagan’, ‘African religion is demonic’, ‘Our ancestors were heathens’, The church as the site of modernity, The missionary school as the school of civilisation, The rejection of African names for Christian names.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH WAIVED

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the ten triads above link into networks, Coloniality scales. The link can be hierarchical (the enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above) or community-based (the witness at one triad becomes the enforcer at another). Both forms are visible in every Nigerian institution, because Coloniality is the air we breathe.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

A Disciplinary Hierarchy is a chain of nested triads. The enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above. Each middle position is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. Coloniality spreads through this form in every Nigerian institution, with five parallel hierarchies corresponding to the five sub-systems.

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak of each hierarchy is the highest Western authority in that sub-system. In the epistemic hierarchy, the peak is the Western peer-reviewed journal and the Western university ranking system. In the linguistic hierarchy, the peak is the English native speaker (real or performed). In the colorism hierarchy, the peak is the lightest skin, often personified in mixed-race or light-skinned celebrities. In the texturism hierarchy, the peak is the Brazilian hair or the Western loose texture. In the colonial Christianity hierarchy, the peak is the Western theological frame and the Western missionary heritage.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. Each middle enforcer is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. The Nigerian professor who defers to the Western journal in the morning demands deference from the Nigerian student in the afternoon. The Nigerian news anchor with the performed British accent demands the same accent from the junior presenter. The light-skinned Nigerian actor demands light skin from the co-star.

The middle is where Coloniality reproduces. The Nigerian subject of today is the enforcer of tomorrow — as the Western-trained academic, the English-speaking professional, the light-skinned media figure, the relaxed-hair corporate manager, the colonial Christian pastor. By the time the Nigerian becomes a senior figure, they have been disciplined by Coloniality for decades.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom of each hierarchy is the most vulnerable Nigerian subject. In the epistemic hierarchy, the Nigerian student whose work is dismissed as anecdotal. In the linguistic hierarchy, the Nigerian who speaks only an indigenous language. In the colorism hierarchy, the darkest-skinned Nigerian. In the texturism hierarchy, the Nigerian with the kinkiest natural hair. In the colonial Christianity hierarchy, the Nigerian who practices indigenous religion. The bottom is where the system's violence

is most concentrated.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. There is no peak, no chain of command. There is only circulation. The witness of one Coloniality triad becomes the enforcer, subject, or witness of another. Coloniality spreads laterally through any Nigerian who has witnessed colonial enforcement without dissenting.

The Western-Trained Academic Networks

The Western-trained academic networks circulate the epistemic standard laterally across the Nigerian university. The Nigerian professor who attended Oxford returns with the Oxford framing. The Nigerian professor who attended Harvard returns with the Harvard framing. The networks reproduce the Western epistemic standard across the Nigerian academy, with no central command issuing the demand.

The English-Speaking Professional Networks

The English-speaking professional networks circulate the English standard laterally across the Nigerian professional class. The Nigerian lawyer who attended the Nigerian Law School performs the English standard. The Nigerian doctor who attended the Nigerian medical school performs the English standard. The networks reproduce the English standard across the Nigerian professions.

The Light-Skinned Solidarity Networks

The light-skinned solidarity networks circulate the light skin standard laterally across the Nigerian media and social elite. The light-skinned news anchor, the light-skinned actor, the light-skinned politician's wife — each circulates the standard by their presence. The networks reproduce the standard across Nigerian public life.

The Wig and Weave Consumer Networks

The wig and weave consumer networks circulate the texturism standard laterally across the Nigerian female professional class. The Nigerian woman who wears the Brazilian weave, the Nigerian woman who wears the relaxed hair, the Nigerian woman who wears the wig — each circulates the standard by their appearance. The networks reproduce the standard across Nigerian professional and social life.

The Colonial Christian Fellowship Networks

The colonial Christian fellowship networks circulate the colonial Christian standard laterally across the Nigerian Christian community. The Nigerian Pentecostal fellowship, the Nigerian Anglican fellowship, the Nigerian Baptist fellowship — each circulates the colonial Christian frame. The networks reproduce the standard across Nigerian religious life.

The Family Pressure Networks

The family pressure networks circulate all five sub-systems laterally across the Nigerian family. The aunt who asks 'when are you getting married to a light-skinned person?' The uncle who asks 'why are

you wearing your hair like that?’ The parent who insists on the English name. The grandparent who insists on the Christian ceremony. The networks reproduce the standards across the Nigerian household.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH WAIVED

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the original colonial officers are dead and replaced, when the colonial networks are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups? What forces new Nigerians to re-form into the same patterns — not because anyone instructs them to, but because the residue makes any other pattern costly or invisible?

Coloniality leaves all three residues. It is one of the most total systems in the framework because it is the residue of a concluded invasion that was never dismantled. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Coloniality simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Coloniality's bureaucracy is the codified colonial-era structure. The English-only official documents that govern Nigerian bureaucratic life. The English-only court proceedings that govern Nigerian legal life. The English-only legislative debates that govern Nigerian political life. The Western-accredited universities that govern Nigerian academic life. The Western-accredited professional bodies (NMC, COREN, ICAN) that govern Nigerian professional life.

The Western-style curriculum that governs Nigerian education from primary to tertiary. The bleaching cream regulatory failure that allows the bleaching cream industry to operate without effective regulation. The cosmetic industry regulation that allows the wig, weave, and perm industries to operate without effective safety standards. The Western theological curriculum in Nigerian seminaries that reproduces the colonial Christian frame.

The colonial-era statutes still in force: the Criminal Code 1916 (which is the basis of Nigerian criminal law in the South), the Marriage Act 1914 (which is the basis of Nigerian marriage law), the various colonial-era ordinances that still govern Nigerian land, labour, and trade. The Western-style family law that governs Nigerian family life. The original colonial authors are dead. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Coloniality's stratification is the daily experience of colonial-era rank in every institutional encounter.

English-speaking/non-English-speaking — the English-speaking Nigerian ranks above the non-English-speaking in every formal setting. **Western-trained/locally-trained** — the Western-trained Nigerian ranks above the locally-trained in academic and professional life.

Light-skinned/dark-skinned — the light-skinned Nigerian ranks above the dark-skinned in media, politics, and corporate life. **Relaxed hair/natural hair** — the relaxed-hair Nigerian ranks above the natural-hair in professional life. **Christian/Muslim/traditionalist** with the colonial Christian frame

as default — the colonial Christian ranks above the Muslim and the traditionalist in public recognition, despite Nigeria's formal secularism.

Western-named/indigenously-named — the Nigerian with a Western name (John, Mary, James, Elizabeth) ranks above the Nigerian with an indigenous name (Ade, Ngozi, Abubakar, Yetunde) in formal settings. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced. Challenging the ranking carries real costs.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Coloniality's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into colonial-era categories. **Western** and **indigenous** — the universal pair, with Western as the legitimate and indigenous as the deficient. **English-speaking** and **non-English-speaking** — the linguistic pair.

Light and **dark** — the colorism pair, with light as the beautiful and dark as the deficient. **Relaxed** and **natural** — the texturism pair, with relaxed as the professional and natural as the unprofessional.

Christian and **pagan** — the religious pair, with Christian as the civilised and pagan as the primitive.

Modern and **traditional** — the temporal pair, with modern as the future and traditional as the past.

Civilised and **primitive** — the moral pair, with civilised as the Western and primitive as the indigenous. **Developed** and **backward** — the economic pair, with developed as the Western and backward as the indigenous. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is Coloniality ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without the Western epistemic standard, without English as the language of formal life, without the light skin standard, without the relaxed hair standard, without the colonial Christian frame — despite the fact that all five are colonial impositions within living memory.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that the colonial-era structure has always been so. Each sub-system has its own Canon. The Epistemic Canon is that the West is the source of knowledge. The Linguistic Canon is that English is the language of sophistication. The Colorism Canon is that light skin is beautiful. The Texturism Canon is that loose or relaxed hair is professional. The Colonial Christianity Canon is that African religion is pagan or demonic.

What is forgotten? Pre-colonial Nigerian knowledge systems were systematic and rigorous. The Ifa corpus is a sophisticated philosophical system with 256 odus, each a complex web of meaning. The Igbo oracle systems (the Agbara, the Alusi, the Afa) were systematic. The Hausa Islamic scholarship (the Sokoto caliphate's intellectual tradition) was rigorous. The Tiv Akombo system was a complex classification of illness and healing.

Also forgotten: that English was imposed through colonial education and that pre-colonial Nigerian languages had sophisticated grammars and literatures. The Yoruba writing system was developed in the 19th century by Samuel Ajayi Crowther, but the oral literature it captured was centuries older. The Igbo, Hausa, and dozens of other languages had sophisticated oral literatures, legal traditions, and philosophical systems.

Also forgotten: that pre-colonial Nigerian beauty standards did not valorise light skin. The Yoruba standard of beauty celebrated dark skin. The Igbo standard celebrated dark skin. The Hausa standard celebrated dark skin. The colonial encounter imposed the Western standard that valorises light skin, and the Canon now presents the light skin standard as natural. That pre-colonial Nigerian hair standards did not valorise loose texture. The Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa standards celebrated indigenous hair textures. The colonial encounter imposed the Western standard.

Also forgotten: that Christianity arrived with the colonial missions in the 1840s (CMS in Badagry, Catholic missions in Lagos and Onitsha) and was imposed through the school system, displacing indigenous religions that had existed for millennia. The Canon presents colonial Christianity as the

natural religion of the civilised. The history shows it as a colonial imposition.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Coloniality produces Stratification. The Western-educated Nigerian's entitlement to epistemic authority is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The Nigerian professor who dismisses the Ifa corpus as 'anecdotal' does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the natural order of academic life. The English-speaking Nigerian's entitlement to linguistic authority is natural. The light-skinned Nigerian's entitlement to beauty authority is natural. The relaxed-hair Nigerian's entitlement to professional authority is natural. The colonial Christian's entitlement to religious authority is natural.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the coloniality-enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The academic who dismisses African sources gains nothing material from each individual dismissal. The English teacher who corrects 'broken' English gains nothing material from each individual correction. The light-skinned person who comments on dark-skinned people's appearance gains nothing material. The hairdresser who recommends relaxing gains nothing material. The pastor who condemns indigenous religion gains nothing material from each individual condemnation. The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the Nigerian subject of each sub-system. The Nigerian academic who cannot cite African sources without Western validation. The Nigerian who is ashamed of their accent. The dark-skinned Nigerian who believes they are less beautiful. The natural-haired Nigerian who believes they are unprofessional. The Nigerian who believes their ancestral religion is demonic. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The deepest form of this is the Nigerian who has absorbed Coloniality so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The Nigerian academic who says 'I cannot cite African sources because they are not peer-reviewed.' The Nigerian who says 'I cannot speak my language in public because it is not professional.' The Nigerian who says 'I cannot be beautiful because I am dark-skinned.' The Nigerian who says 'I cannot wear my natural hair because it is unprofessional.' The Nigerian who says 'I cannot practice my ancestral religion because it is demonic.' The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. The Nigerian enforcer forgets they can choose not to enforce. The Nigerian subject forgets they can rebel. The Nigerian witness forgets they can dissent. Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body.

Anibal Quijano showed how the coloniality of power persists in the body of the post-colonial subject: the Nigerian who reflexively defers to the Western frame, who reflexively cites the Western source, who reflexively adopts the Western standard. Walter Dignolo showed how the coloniality of knowledge is performed in the daily citation, the daily framing, the daily use of the Western theoretical canon. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By the time the Nigerian child is twelve, the colonial-era standards are reflex. They know English is the language of school. They know the Western textbook is the authority. They know the light-skinned classmate is the beautiful one. They know the relaxed hair is the neat hair. They know the Christian prayer is the official prayer. By adulthood, the Nigerian has performed the five sub-systems' triads so many thousands of times that the alternative — citing African sources, speaking their language, embracing dark skin, wearing natural hair, practicing indigenous religion — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Coloniality is spectacular: the death of the Nigerian who dies from bleaching cream complications — the kidney failure, the skin cancer, the mercury poisoning that the bleaching cream industry inflicts on its consumers. The death of the Nigerian who dies from unsafe cosmetic procedures — the failed relaxer, the infected weave, the unlicensed cosmetic surgery.

The violence against indigenous religion practitioners — the assault on the Babalawo, the destruction of the shrine, the killing of the traditional priest by the mob that has internalised the colonial Christian Canon. The death of the indigenous language speaker who cannot access healthcare because the healthcare is in English — the elderly Yoruba speaker who cannot explain their symptoms to the English-speaking doctor, the Igbo speaker who cannot read the prescription, the Hausa speaker who cannot understand the consent form.

The suicide of the Nigerian academic who cannot meet Western publication standards — the academic who has internalised the Western epistemic standard so deeply that the failure to publish in Western journals registers as personal failure. The killing of the 'witch child' by colonial-Christian-influenced deliverance ministries — the Akwa Ibom and Cross River cases where children accused of witchcraft are tortured and killed by self-styled deliverance ministers who have internalised the colonial Christian framing of indigenous belief as demonic.

Slow death in Coloniality is quiet. The slow death of indigenous languages — the United Nations estimates that many Nigerian languages will be extinct by the end of the century, killed by the Linguicism that valorises English. The slow death of indigenous knowledge systems — the Ifa corpus, the Igbo oracle systems, the Tiv Akombo, killed by the Epistemic Oppression that valorises Western knowledge.

The slow death of indigenous religions — the ceremonies that can no longer be performed because the knowledge is lost, killed by the Colonial Christianity that valorises the colonial Christian frame. The slow death of indigenous beauty standards — the celebration of dark skin that has been replaced by the bleaching cream industry. The slow death of indigenous names — the Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa

names that have been replaced by English names.

The chronic stress of navigating Western standards with a Nigerian body — the Nigerian academic who has internalised the Western epistemic standard, the Nigerian professional who has internalised the English standard, the dark-skinned Nigerian who has internalised the light skin standard, the natural-haired Nigerian who has internalised the relaxed hair standard, the Nigerian who has internalised the colonial Christian Canon. The mental health collapse from internalised inferiority. The cumulative erasure of self that produces the Nigerian who no longer knows who they are outside the colonial frame. None of these make the news. They are Coloniality's quiet tax.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore's definition applies: Coloniality produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are the indigenous language speakers, the indigenous religion practitioners, the dark-skinned Nigerians, the natural-haired Nigerians, the Nigerian academics who cannot meet Western standards, the 'witch children.' The premature death is fast (bleaching cream complications, cosmetic procedure failures, mob violence against indigenous religion, witch child killings, suicide) or slow (language death, knowledge death, religion death, beauty standard death, name death, chronic stress, mental health collapse, self-erasure). Every ascended matrix kills. Coloniality kills those whose relation to the colonial frame does not fit.

SECTION 6

6. When Did Coloniality Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did Coloniality rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory, such that the average Nigerian cannot recall a time when its structural residue was not present? This is not a history of how Coloniality was built. It is a diagnosis of when the building was forgotten.

Pre-colonial Nigerian knowledge systems were systematic and rigorous. The Ifa corpus, the Igbo oracle systems, the Hausa Islamic scholarship, the Tiv Akombo — each was a knowledge system that had carried its community for centuries. Pre-colonial Nigerian languages were the default of education, government, and commerce. Pre-colonial Nigerian beauty standards did not valorise light skin. Pre-colonial Nigerian hair standards did not valorise loose texture. Pre-colonial Nigerian religion was the default of public life.

Colonial codification (1900-1960) imposed the Western epistemic standard through the colonial university and the colonial curriculum. English was imposed through the colonial school and the colonial office. The light skin standard was imposed through colonial media and colonial aesthetics. The loose/relaxed hair standard was imposed through colonial aesthetics. Colonial Christianity was imposed through the colonial mission and the colonial school. Each imposition was a political decision, not a natural development.

Post-independence replication continued the displacement. The Nigerian university retained the Western epistemic standard. The Nigerian court retained the English language. The Nigerian media retained the light skin standard. The Nigerian office retained the relaxed hair standard. The Nigerian church retained the colonial Christian frame. Each retention was a continuation, not an indigenous arrangement.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1960** for the formal transition from colonial rule to post-colonial rule, which preserved the colonial epistemic, linguistic, aesthetic, and religious infrastructure. For Nigerians born after 1960 — the post-independence generation — Coloniality has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when English was not the language of formal life, when Western knowledge was not the standard, when light skin was not beautiful, when relaxed hair was not professional, when colonial Christianity was not the default religion.

The pre-coloniality generation (born ~1890s-1910s) was the last to have living memory of pre-colonial knowledge systems, indigenous languages as the default, indigenous beauty standards, indigenous hair standards, and indigenous religion as the default. By independence (1960), that generation had been displaced from policy-making by the colonial-trained elite, and the colonial infrastructure had become the natural order. The question 'is the Western epistemic standard natural?' had stopped being asked in popular memory by the 1970s. The question 'is English natural?' stopped being asked by the 1960s. The question 'is the light skin standard natural?' stopped being asked by the 1980s. The question 'is the

relaxed hair standard natural?” stopped being asked by the 1990s. The question ‘is colonial Christianity natural?’ stopped being asked by the 1960s.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you. They are not rhetorical. This chapter’s blanks are especially personal: every Nigerian reader will find themselves in at least three of the five sub-systems, because Coloniality is the air we breathe. The point of the framework is not to understand Coloniality in the abstract. It is to locate yourself inside it.

Question 1: When did Coloniality rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The person who first made you feel that challenging the colonial-era standard was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The colonial-era standard you assumed in that moment was: _____. The form of address you used was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____. The sub-system of Coloniality at the centre of the moment (Epistemic Oppression, Linguicism, Colorism, Texturism, Colonial Christianity) was: _____.

Question 2: How is Coloniality causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from Coloniality is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress from years of performing the colonial-era standard; the insomnia from years of swallowing the Western framing; the loss of self from years of being told my language is vernacular, my skin is too dark, my hair is unprofessional, my religion is pagan; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the relationship I lost because I could not stop performing the colonial-era standard at home; the medical diagnosis I now live with because the bleaching cream damaged my kidneys; the medical diagnosis I now live with because the relaxer damaged my scalp; the indigenous language I no longer speak because English displaced it; the indigenous religion I cannot practice because the colonial Christian Canon made it demonic.) The matrix’s name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside Coloniality. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the academic dismisses African sources, the next time the English

teacher corrects ‘broken’ English, the next time the bleaching cream advert plays, the next time the office dress code forbids natural hair, the next time the pastor condemns indigenous religion — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition. And if you are now the enforcer in the triad — the academic, the English teacher, the bleaching cream consumer, the relaxed-hair professional, the colonial Christian — the sight is also the beginning of your refusal to enforce.

SECTION 8

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Coming Next

Chapter 12 will take up Somatic Normativity — the system that ranks able bodies above disabled bodies, sane minds above mad minds, and conventionally-attractive faces above unconventional ones. The framework's outline names its sub-faces: Ableism, Sanism, Lookism, and Sizeism. Somatic Normativity overlaps with Coloniality (Chapter 11) at the point where Western beauty standards (Colorism, Texturism) intersect with Ableism and Lookism. The framework separates them so that the bodily-capacity and appearance logic specifically can be studied and dismantled.

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the order continues: Chapter 13 is Retributivism, Chapter 14 is Amatonormativity, Chapter 15 is Compulsory Existence / Suicidism, and so on through the Fundamental Matrices. Each chapter follows the same template established in Chapters 2 through 11. The naive approach in the first three domains (or its waiver, as in this chapter). The Ascension Ritual in the fourth. The historical memory trace. The fill-in-the-blank. The endnotes. The pattern is now set.